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Steering Clear of Toxins During Pregnancy

Simple steps to protect you and your baby from harmful chemical exposures

⚠️ WHY IT MATTERS

🔴 Risks of Toxic Exposures

- Premature birth
- Low birth weight
- Developmental & cognitive issues
- Childhood and adult cancers
- Interference with fetal development

Toxic chemicals can be found in air, water, food, and everyday products. During pregnancy, certain chemicals can interfere with the normal development of your baby.

🥦 SAFER FOOD CHOICES

- 🍳 Heat food in **glass or ceramic** — not plastic containers
- 🏡 Cook more meals at home using **fresh, local ingredients**
- 🥫 Select **BPA-free** canned foods when possible
- 🌾 Choose **USDA organic** produce to reduce pesticide exposure
- 🚿 **Wash all produce** thoroughly before eating

🐟 High-Mercury Fish to AVOID:

- Bigeye tuna · King mackerel
- Shark · Swordfish · Tilefish

✨ BEAUTY & HOME PRODUCTS

Ingredients to AVOID in personal care products:

- Phthalates
- Parabens
- Oxybenzone (sunscreen)
- Triclosan (antibacterial soaps)
- Strong synthetic fragrances

- 🔍 Use **EWG's Skin Deep database** to research product safety
- 🏷️ Look for **"fragrance-free"** labels — not just "unscented"
- 🧹 Use **vinegar + baking soda** as safe cleaning alternatives

🍳 KITCHEN & HOME SAFETY

- 🍳 Replace **nonstick cookware** with ceramic, stainless steel, or cast iron
- 🗄️ Use **glass, ceramic, or stainless steel** for food storage
- 🏠 **Lead paint:** Avoid home renovations in older homes; use wet cleaning to reduce lead dust
- 🚭 Avoid all **secondhand smoke** — there is no safe level during pregnancy
- 👕 Limit **dry cleaning** — pick up clothes promptly or air out before wearing

🌬️ AIR, WORK & ENVIRONMENT

- 😷 **Poor air quality days:** Stay indoors; check AirNow.gov for local alerts
- 🌡️ Avoid **extreme heat** — overheating increases risk of birth defects
- 🏭 **High-risk workplaces:** Farming, factories, healthcare — discuss exposures with your OB/GYN
- ⚖️ Your employer must provide a **safe working environment** — you have rights
- 🤲 **Wash hands frequently** — especially before eating and after handling products

📋 KEY REMINDERS

- 💧 Use **filtered water** for drinking and cooking; check local water quality reports
- 🌊 Avoid **swimming in polluted waters** or areas with algal blooms
- 🐾 Use **low-toxicity pest control** — avoid pesticide spraying at home
- 📱 Consult **EWG.org** or **healthybabycodes.org** for product safety research
- 🩺 Always discuss **any specific exposures** with Dr. Klein at your prenatal visits

Questions? We're Here to Help.

Every pregnancy is unique. If you have concerns about a specific chemical exposure at home, work, or in your environment, please discuss it with Dr. Klein. We're committed to helping you and your baby stay as healthy as possible throughout your pregnancy.